Michael Kurdi

Junior Security Analyst | Security Operations | IT Risk

Charlotte, NC (US citizen; remote, hybrid or onsite) · kurdi.michael.it@gmail.com · LinkedIn · GitHub · Portfolio

SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate (B.S. Information Technologies, Cybersecurity concentration, summa cum laude, 3.96 GPA) with CompTIA Security+. Eight years in a federally regulated aviation operation, validating identity, controlling access, documenting to inspection standards and escalating with clear facts. Public projects in log anomaly detection and phishing email classification.

SKILLS

Hands-on (labs): Network troubleshooting (Packet Tracer), Windows GPO hardening (GNS3), MySQL and SQL

Coursework: Incident analysis (CIA, NIST), IAM and CIS Controls, threat modeling, cloud business continuity and disaster recovery planning

Familiar with: SIEM concepts and vocabulary, Python security tooling, vulnerability scanning (exposure, not production ownership)

Regulated work: FAA, OSHA, IATA and CBP requirements; identity validation; access control; inspection-ready documentation; escalation with clear facts

PROJECTS AND COURSEWORK

Security projects

Public repositories

github.com/KM-it-ops

- Log anomaly detection: rule-based and statistical detection of brute force, port scans, off-hours file access and privilege escalation.
- Phishing email classifier.
- VulnTrack, a vulnerability dashboard.
- SniffOutPro, a local vulnerability-assessment app.
- ATT&CKLens benchmark.
- Incident response playbooks and a cyber defense playbook.

Proofhouse

Personal project, github.com/KM-it-ops/Proofhouse

- Directed the AI-assisted development of Proofhouse, a prompt-optimizing tool for non-expert users.
- Works across multiple AI providers and models (14 providers), and researches and adds a new one when a user asks for it.
- Used by non-expert users to get translations in the right dialect and image-generator results that fit Middle Eastern culture.
- Decided each design choice and tested every part as it was built.

Coursework labs

Coursework

Southern New Hampshire University

- CYB-220: Windows GPO hardening in GNS3 with six endpoint restrictions.
- CYB-210: when the first ping in a Packet Tracer lab dropped a packet, retested, compared host pairs and wrote up the failure and the recovery (VLANs, DHCP, ASA adjacency).
- CYB-260: CIS Controls plus HIPAA-aligned service-level brief.
- DAD-220: MySQL database built from an ERD.

EXPERIENCE

Delivery Associate

Jun 2025 to Aug 2026

Fossa Logistics LLC (delivery service provider for Amazon)

- Delivered Amazon packages in a high-tempo operation with route prioritization, customer exceptions and hard time windows.
- Informal peer troubleshooting for 7 drivers: walked one through the electric van's troubleshooting reset by phone, fixed another's intermittent signal loss by resetting the phone's cellular connection, and found what was draining a third phone's battery.
- Spent 2.5 hours working with another driver to free a stuck electric delivery van from a muddy slope, then split the load and finished my route plus half of hers: on-time delivery, no customer incident.

Rural Carrier Associate

Jun 2024 to Jun 2025

USPS, Kannapolis, NC

- Learned 8 of the office's 15 routes (only one was required) and, on many days, delivered multiple routes start to finish.
- Handled mail, certified documentation, priority packages and sensitive materials on time-critical routes.
- Used handheld devices for navigation, inventory management, time management and delivery completion.

Ramp Agent, then Crew Chief (Aviation Security Operations)

Mar 2015 to Nov 2023

American Airlines, Charlotte, NC

- Crew Chief for 6 years (2017 to 2023): led a team of 3 to 9 agents on a rotating crew; size varied with aircraft type, departing station and cargo.
- Cleared by U.S. Customs and Border Protection to handle live inbound and outbound international flights, and cleared for international and high-profile arrivals.
- Handled up to 5 flights per 8-hour shift (3.5 on average), including weekly charter flights for a professional football team in season. Asked to stay and work later inbound arrivals because of my international-flight certifications.
- Caught security and dangerous-goods discrepancies on international flights.
- Used a handheld device to clear security checks, plan weight-and-balance trip sheets, handle dangerous-goods clearances and warnings to flight crew, track luggage in transit, and contact ATC, the FAA or local law enforcement when policy required.
- Worked under FAA, OSHA, IATA and CBP requirements with recurrent incident-response and safety and security training: daily identity validation, access control, and documentation that had to hold up to inspection.
- Earned D1 certification (2017): crew chief and weight-and-balance clearance, FAA-compliant. Lapsed on leaving American Airlines.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Southern New Hampshire University, B.S. Information Technologies, Cybersecurity concentration. Completed Dec 2025, conferred Jan 2026. Summa Cum Laude, 3.96 GPA. Alpha Sigma Lambda honor society. Studied at night, through audio lessons while working, and on days off.

CompTIA Security+ ce (SY0-701), issued Jan 2025, valid through Jan 2028